12-31 第一篇

New Year Traditions Around the World

People everywhere celebrate the start of a new year. Different cultures have their own customs—some shared, some unique. In many places, midnight on 31 December marks the turning point. Fireworks light up the sky, and people count down together. The new year is seen as a chance to leave the past behind and start fresh. [1]

Food often plays a special role. In Spain, people eat 12 grapes at midnight—one for each chime of the clock—to bring luck for each month. In the southern United States, black-eyed peas and greens are eaten for prosperity. In China, dumplings at Lunar New Year symbolise wealth and family unity. These foods link celebration with hopes for the year ahead. [2]

Many people make New Year resolutions. They promise to exercise more, study harder, or give up a bad habit. Resolutions show our desire to improve, even if we do not always keep them. Writing down goals and sharing them with others can make success more likely. The new year offers a natural moment to reflect and plan. [3]

Cleaning and decorating are common. In Japan, people clean their homes before the new year to welcome good fortune. In Scotland, "first-footing" means the first person to enter a home after midnight should bring gifts like coal or whisky. These rituals create a sense of order and hope as the calendar turns. [4]

New Year traditions connect us to our culture and to each other. They remind us that time moves forward and that we can choose how to use it. Whether we stay up until midnight, share a meal, or set new goals, we join millions around the world in welcoming another year of possibilities. [5]

选项

A. In short, the new year is a global moment of celebration and renewal, with both shared and unique customs. B. For these reasons, special foods are a way to wish for luck and happiness in the coming year. C. That is why resolutions, even when broken, still reflect our wish to grow and do better. D. These practices show that preparation and symbolism are part of welcoming the new year. E. In other words, New Year traditions unite us in hope and in the belief that we can shape our future. F. For example, the Times Square Ball Drop in New York draws over a million visitors each year.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- [1] A：
  - **线索**：空前介绍各地庆祝新年、不同文化有共同与独特习俗、12月31日午夜为转折、烟花倒计时、新年被视为告别过去重新开始的机会，空后需总结新年的全球性与更新意义。A的"global moment of celebration and renewal, with both shared and unique customs"与前文对应。
- [2] B：
  - **线索**：空前举例新年食物——西班牙12颗葡萄、美国南方黑眼豆与绿叶菜、中国饺子象征财富与团圆、食物联结庆典与对来年的期盼，空后需总结特殊食物与祝福的关系。B的"special foods are a way to wish for luck and happiness in the coming year"与前文呼应。
- [3] C：
  - **线索**：空前说许多人做新年决心——运动、学习、戒除恶习、体现改善愿望、写下目标与人分享可提高成功率、新年提供反思与规划的时机，空后需总结决心即使未完成仍反映成长愿望。C的"resolutions, even when broken, still reflect our wish to grow and do better"与前文对应。
- [4] D：
  - **线索**：空前说打扫与装饰普遍——日本年前大扫除以迎福、苏格兰"first-footing"带礼物入户、这些仪式在岁末营造秩序与希望，空后需总结准备与象征在迎新中的角色。D的"preparation and symbolism are part of welcoming the new year"与前文呼应。
- [5] E：
  - **线索**：空前说新年传统联结文化与彼此、提醒我们时间向前我们可选择如何利用、无论守岁、共餐还是设定目标，我们都与全球一起迎接新的一年，空后需总结传统在希望与塑造未来信念上的作用。E的"unite us in hope and in the belief that we can shape our future"与前文对应。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, the Times Square Ball Drop in New York...**：以For example开头，为具体新年活动案例（时代广场倒计时）。各空均为概括或过渡句；[1]易被误选因涉及午夜庆祝，但该空需总结新年的全球性与更新意义，而非某一地点的活动描述。